

| Assessment | Test | Domain  | Skill                            | Difficulty                                          |
|------------|------|---------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| SAT        | Math | Algebra | Linear equations in one variable | Medium <div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |

Question

The cost to rent a bus from Company X is **\$950** for the first **3** hours and an additional **\$50** per hour for each hour after the first **3** hours. If the total cost to rent the bus from Company X for  $t$  hours, where  $t > 3$ , is **\$1,150**, which equation represents this situation?

Answer

- A.  $950(t - 3) + 50t = 1,150$
- B.  $950(3t) + 50t = 1,150$
- C.  $950 + 50(t - 3) = 1,150$
- D.  $950 + 50(3t) = 1,150$

Correct Answer: C

Rationale

Choice C is correct. It’s given that the cost to rent a bus is **\$950** for the first **3** hours and an additional **\$50** per hour for each hour after the first **3** hours. It’s also given that  $t$  represents the total number of hours and  $t > 3$ . Therefore, the number of additional hours after the first **3** hours can be represented by the expression  $t - 3$ . The cost for these additional hours is **\$50** per hour, so the cost for the additional hours can be represented by the expression  $50(t - 3)$ . The total cost can be calculated by adding the cost for the first **3** hours to the cost for the additional hours and can be represented by the expression  $950 + 50(t - 3)$ . It’s also given that the total cost to rent the bus from the company for  $t$  hours is **\$1,150**. Thus, the equation that represents this situation is  $950 + 50(t - 3) = 1,150$ .

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual errors.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual errors.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual errors.